

Competition 01 — Competitive Programming

Overview

Competitive Programming at Spectrum 26 is a two-day algorithmic challenge where individuals and teams race to solve problems under time pressure. Day 1 is a preliminary round open to all registered participants. A select number of top performers advance to Day 2's final round, which features harder problems and higher stakes.

Submissions are automatically scored. Top entries are manually reviewed for integrity before results are finalised.

Participation format: Solo, Duo, or Triplet

Venue: DHA Suffa University Computer Labs

Duration: 2-Day Event (June 8 and 9, 2026)

Tools and environment: Standard IDE compilers for C++, Python, and Java are pre-configured on lab machines. No AI tools, ChatGPT, external search, or any assistance tools are permitted during either round.

Registration Fees

Solo — Rs. 500

Duo — Rs. 1,000

Triplet — Rs. 1,500

Timeline and Format

Day 1 — Preliminary Round (June 8)

Duration: 60 minutes

All registered participants compete simultaneously across 4 to 5 computer labs. Problems span a range from easy to medium difficulty — implementation, greedy, math, and basic data structures. Scoring is automatic via HackerRank or VJudge based on problem difficulty weight and test cases passed. A select number of top performers advance to Day 2. The exact number of qualifiers is determined by the module management and will be communicated after Day 1 results are reviewed. Not all participants will qualify. In the event of a score tie at the cutoff, the participant or team with the lower cumulative submission time takes priority.

After Day 1 ends, top submissions are manually reviewed for plagiarism and AI-generated code patterns before the finalist list is published.

Day 2 — Grand Final (June 9)

Duration: 90 minutes

Finalists only. The problem set steps up significantly — medium to hard difficulty covering graphs, dynamic programming, and advanced data structures. The same automatic scoring and tie-breaking rules apply. All finalist submissions undergo a mandatory integrity review before results are confirmed.

Results and Prize Distribution

Winners are announced after the integrity audit clears. Prize distribution follows immediately at the awards ceremony.

Judging Rubric

Automatic Scoring Score is computed entirely by HackerRank or VJudge based on problem difficulty weight and the number of test cases passed. This applies to both rounds.

Tie-breaking When two participants or teams finish with equal scores, the one with the lower total cumulative submission time wins.

Integrity Review — Pass or Fail Top submissions from both rounds are manually reviewed for plagiarism and AI-generated code. A failed integrity review results in immediate disqualification regardless of score.

Prize Breakdown

1st place — Rs. 20,000

2nd place — Rs. 10,000

3rd place — Certificate and goodies, recognised on stage at the awards ceremony

Total prize pool: Rs. 30,000

Rules and Regulations

No plagiarism or code sharing between teams at any point during either round.

No AI code generation tools of any kind — including ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Claude, or any similar tool — are permitted during the competition.

No external collaboration or communication with anyone outside the registered team during either round.

Any violation at any stage results in immediate disqualification with no refund.

Lab and logistics notes

4 to 6 computer labs will be pre-configured with browser access restricted to the competition platform domain only. All other internet traffic is blocked at the network level. Proctors will be present in each lab throughout both rounds. The Competition Head holds final disqualification authority.